Service for Cooks

A trust-first marketplace for home cooks and households

Business Model Document , Bengaluru, India

1. The Opportunity

MARKET GAP	CUSTOMER PAIN
Talented cooks with no platform Millions of skilled home cooks, hobbyists, and underemployed chefs have real culinary talent but no structured way to monetise it. Their only channel is informal word-of-mouth , no profile, no bookings, no income security.	**No trusted way to hire a cook** Busy households who want homestyle meal prep cannot find vetted, affordable cooks. Expensive caterers or strangers from generic gig apps offer no social proof and no recurring relationship.

Market signals

- ~40 million households in India actively spending on outsourced cooking or meal prep
- The home chef / meal prep gig market is growing at 15–20% annually
- Zero trust-first cook marketplaces exist in India today
- Bengaluru's dual-income urban households are the ideal launch segment

2. The Gap

The gap is not about supply or demand, both exist. The gap is trust infrastructure. Existing platforms (UrbanCompany, Sulekha, Facebook groups) either treat cooks as commodities with no identity, or rely on self-reported ratings with no accountability. Neither builds the long-term cook–household relationship that makes meal prep work.

WHAT EXISTS	WHAT'S MISSING	THE OPPORTUNITY
Generic gig apps UrbanCompany, Sulekha. Task-focused, no cuisine identity, high churn, no social proof from real clients.	**Trust layer** No platform asks real past clients to vouch for a cook before they go live. No background check + social proof combination.	**Relationship marketplace** A platform where trust is the product. Cooks carry a verified reputation, households build a lasting cooking relationship.

3. How the Platform Works

The platform connects cooks and households through a structured, trust-gated listing system.

Cook profile includes

- Cuisine speciality (e.g. Bengali, South Indian, Jain, etc.)

- Dietary offerings — veg / non-veg / vegan
- Availability slots and service frequency
- Location and areas served
- Ratings and reviews from verified hirers
- Sample menu and food photos

What a hirer does

- Search by cuisine type and dietary preference
- Filter by area and available timing
- View full cook profile and verified reviews
- Contact directly via WhatsApp or in-app messaging
- Agree on terms and recurring schedule directly
- Leave a verified review after service

Cooks Bengali, South Indian, etc.	**Your platform** Profiles + availability Search by cuisine / area	**Households** Bengaluru families

4. What Needs to Be Done

Phase 1 — Seed with existing trust

Onboard cooks who already have loyal customers. Those customers become the first vouchers, bootstrapping the reputation graph without cold-starting from zero.

- Identify 20–30 active home cooks in Bengaluru with existing client bases
- Invite their clients to vouch for them on the platform
- Require minimum 3 vouches + background check before a cook goes live

Phase 2 — Build the listing infrastructure

- Cook onboarding flow: profile creation, cuisine tagging, availability calendar
- Background check integration (third-party verification API)
- Vouch request flow: cook invites past clients via WhatsApp / SMS
- Search and filter: cuisine, area, timing, dietary preference

Phase 3 — Bookings and payments

- In-app scheduling with recurring booking support
- Secure payment flow with escrow-style payout to cooks
- Review and rating system locked to verified bookings only
- WhatsApp-native contact for households already used to this channel

5. Revenue Model

Revenue decisions can be deferred until the platform has traction. The three viable options are:

PRIMARY	SECONDARY	TERTIARY
Platform commission	**Cook subscription**	**Featured listing**
15–20% take rate on each booking. Cook sets price, platform handles payment, insurance, and trust layer.	Optional premium tier for cooks , priority placement, analytics dashboard, unlimited listings. ~₹500–800/mo.	Cooks pay to appear at the top of search results within their cuisine / area category.

6. The Moat

The defensible advantages that make this business hard to replicate quickly:

Social proof flywheel	Every vouch is a signal that accumulates over time. A cook's reputation becomes non-portable , it lives on the platform. The more vouches they accumulate, the harder they are to be displaced by a competitor.
Trust as a brand	Vouching + background checks is a bar that competitors can copy technically but not quickly. Being the 'vetted' option is a positioning moat. Urban families will pay a premium for safety and reliability.
Recurring relationships	Weekly meal prep creates habitual, sticky bookings. Once a household finds a cook they trust, the switching cost is high. This drives strong retention on both sides of the marketplace.
Network lock-in	A cook's voucher network lives on the platform. Leaving means starting the reputation graph over from scratch. Customers' order history, preferences, and cook relationships are also locked in.

7. How You Grow

CHANNEL 1	CHANNEL 2	CHANNEL 3
Instagram funnel	**Word of mouth**	**Expand categories**
Short cooking videos and stories from cooks drive organic discovery. Stories link directly to the cook's profile on the platform.	Cooks refer to other cooks. Households refer to other households. A referral credit system accelerates this on both sides.	Start with meal prep. Expand to cleaning, drivers, and other blue-collar home services once the trust layer is proven.

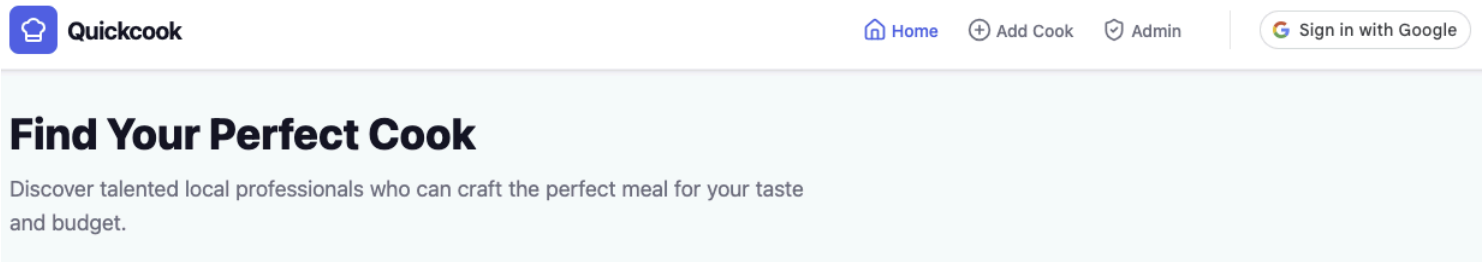
Yeah what's next

The consumer taste and preference is at an all-time high now. Considering we have a platform built, we need to ensure that the website emotes credibility. The current website needs some refinements.

https://quickcook-frontend.vercel.app/

Copy to be changed

Current

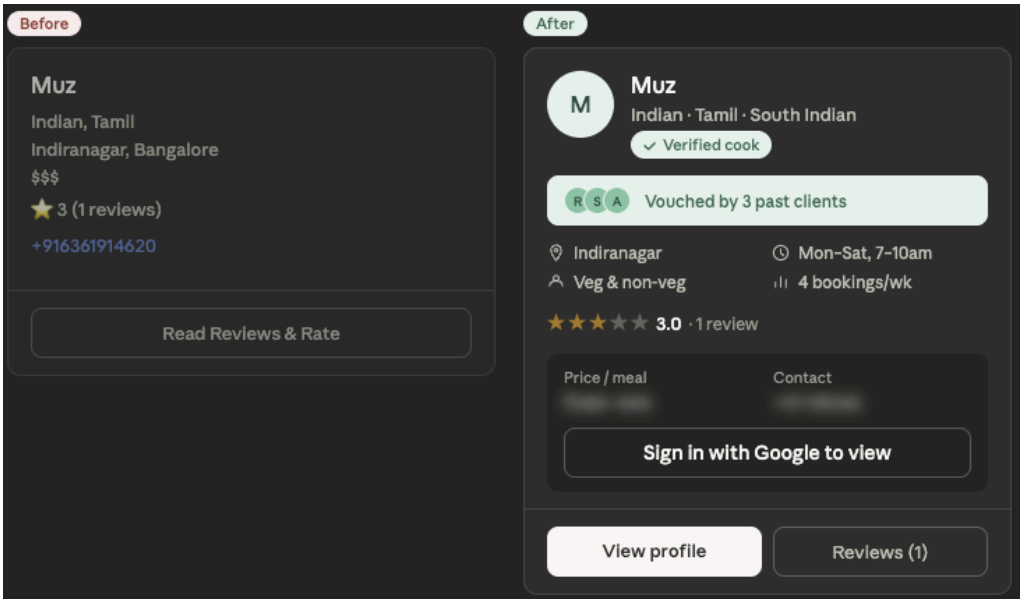


New

Home-cooked food, from someone your neighbours already trust.
Find a cook who knows your cuisine, your diet, and your schedule and actually shows up every week.

Reasoning
Jeet's demand from instagram story is based on relationship first and nothing else. Considering Manik Da's relatability, folks want his skills in their kitchen and tummies full reminiscing their home cooked food which cannot be recreated in restaurant/food places.

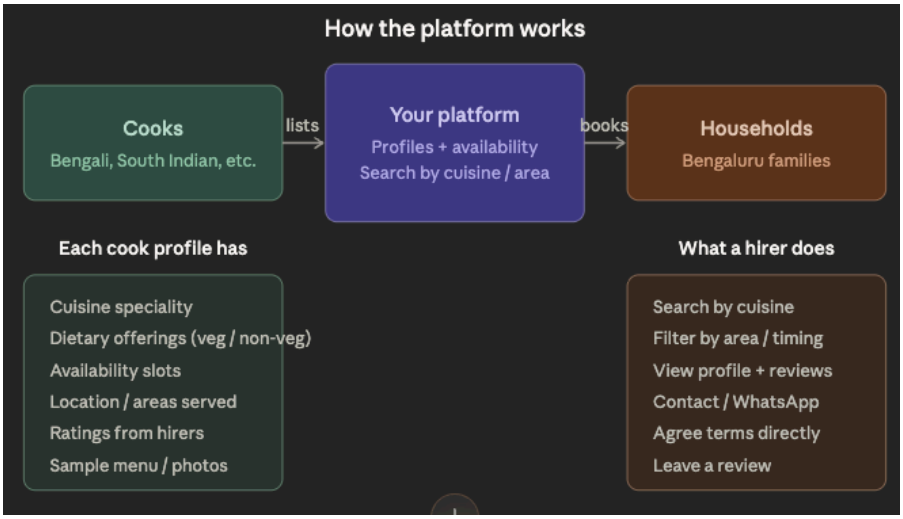
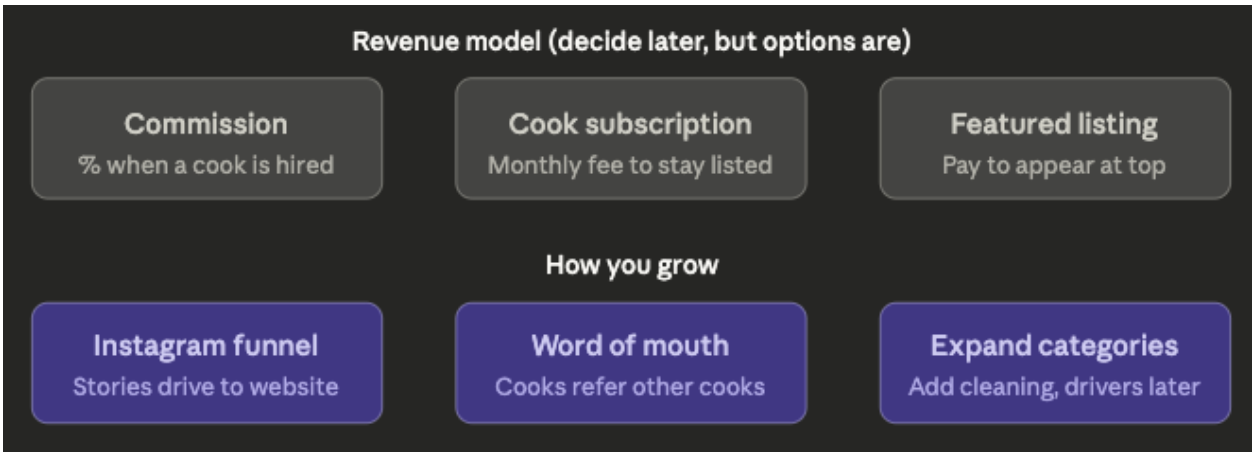
Listing cards



Both price and contact are now locked behind sign-in. The blurred values hint that real data exists, creating curiosity, while the "Sign in →" link is a low-friction conversion nudge directly on the card.

[NOW] Website that is trust worthy (we should build this) -

@mu2amm1l help us with this.

- https://claude.ai/public/artifacts/f1ab3eaf-696b-4499-8bf7-9acc1984ee42
- Code - https://github.com/1neophyte2/quickcook

Working notes (medium-long term)